Amid these global presences, Bihar's own Patna Kalam paintings are set to anchor the Biennale in its local soil, offering a visual history of daily life and artistry under colonial patronage. These paintings were developed in Patna under the patronage of the British by combining the Indian miniature painting style and the western style. One of the first art styles in the world to give place to common people and their daily life on canvas, more than one hundred and fifty paintings of Patna Kalam will be on display in the exhibition in October at Patna Museum Temporary Gallery. Apart from the paintings preserved in the Patna Museum, it also includes paintings lent by Sanjay Kumar, Dhanbad, a descendant of the famous Patna Kalam painter Hulas Lal.

Among the Biennale's most resonant displays is **"Vishwaroop Ram: The Universal Legacy of Ramayana" (7th August to 7th September)**, presented by the Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) in the Children's Gallery Classroom. This exhibition brings together Ramayana-inspired artefacts, traditions, and art forms from around twenty countries, embodying not only a remarkable curatorial scale but also a deep cultural intention—to acknowledge the epic's global footprints. It traces the Ramayana's journey along the routes of trade, migration, performance, and oral tradition, showing how it is embraced and adapted by diverse societies. From Bali's masked theatre to Trinidad's folk memory, from Valmiki's Sanskrit verses to Tulsidas's Ramcharitmanas in Awadhi, each telling reflects the tongue, terrain, and time that shapes it. The display invites visitors to encounter Rama in his many manifestations—God and hero, exiled and king, son and symbol—highlighting the Ramayana's enduring vitality as a shared cultural legacy across civilisations.

A Cultural Map Redrawn

Though August marked the most concentrated period of events, the third edition exhibitions are continuing through the final months of 2025. **"An Argentine Walk" (17th September – 30th October)** by Pablo Katlirevsky offers photographic narratives as intimate as they are expansive. This wide-ranging photography exhibition invites you on a journey to discover the stories, the landscapes and the soul of Argentina through the photographs. This exhibition is like taking a walk around Argentina to experience the frozen moments, the glances that cross out and look at photography as a witness to those things that should not get lost in oblivion.

"Peru: A Country of Inexhaustible Wonders" (7th October – 7th November) invites visitors on a journey of discovery of Peru through mixing history and textiles with tales of culture. The textiles and reproduction of different types of clothes and accessories narrates the tale of the different ancient Peruvian cultures. Along with this, the sixty-four fine replicas of pottery and clay artefacts and Pre-Inca ceramics produced by Andean civilisations developed between 900 BC to 1000 AD in different regions of Peru offer a peek into the daily lives and beliefs.

Later to come in the Biennale's calendar, **"Home in a Space Left Behind" (7th November–7th December)** turns the lens inward, exploring the idea of 'home' in the work of diasporic artists from the Caribbean and the Indian Ocean alongside voices from Bihar. Drawing from archival materials and cultural references, it reimagines memory and identity through the lived experiences of migration, displacement, and return. **"The Origin of Cacao" (16th November–31st December)** traces Ecuador's unique ecological and cultural heritage as the true birthplace of cacao, revealing archaeological evidence from over 5,500 years ago and connecting it to the global traditions of chocolate-making. **"Shakti – The Supreme Goddess" (7th November–31st December)**, a luminous display of miniature paintings from the Mehrangarh Museum Trust, depicts Devī as the primordial cosmic energy—Creator, Preserver, and Destroyer—beyond all human dualities. And in a striking fusion of heritage and technology, **"Double Truth II" (15th December 2025–30th June 2026)** offers an interactive installation that uses cutting-edge reproduction techniques to bring significant Jain, Hindu, and Buddhist artefacts from the Bihar Museum's own collections into an immersive, sensory-rich experience, ensuring that the Biennale's impact extends far beyond its opening week.

The 2025 Biennale is an invitation to remember differently, to imagine together, and to share across the lines that have long divided. In doing so, it marks not just an exhibition, but a movement—towards a world where histories are not owned, but held in common. It has proven that a museum in the heart of Patna can be both local and global, intimate and expansive, and has demonstrated that the Global South is not a silent periphery but a polyphonic centre—its histories woven from trade winds and migration routes, from rituals and revolutions, from the enduring urge to create. In the coming weeks and months, as the remaining exhibitions continue to draw visitors, the Biennale stands as a testament to Bihar's capacity to convene the world and to speak in its own voice, resonating far beyond the museum walls.

